



Getting Started with Claude

Login. First wins. The few prompts you will use every week. Everything you need to make AI part of how you work, in one sitting.

First session ready

Prompt library inside

Updated September 2026



WELCOME

Why this guide exists

Claude is the AI tool we have adopted across CGP. The team that uses it well will draft faster, think more clearly, and get better at the part of the job that matters most: the conversations and decisions that move our clubs forward.

This is not a manual for AI. It is a starter kit for your work, built around the things you actually do at CGP. If you read it once and try three of the prompts, you are ahead.

This edition reflects what has changed through September 2026: a taller model lineup, Claude working inside Microsoft Office, Cowork on desktop, web, and mobile, memory that now carries between chat and Cowork, and Claude in your browser. The fundamentals have not changed. Good input, good judgment, good results.

Jim Creighton · Director, People Development & Innovation

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BEFORE YOU START

How to use this guide

Three ways in, depending on how much time you have right now.

If you have ten minutes

Read Part 1, get logged in, and try Win #2 on page 9. Rescue an email you have been putting off. That is a complete first session and you will have something useful out of it.

If you have an hour

Parts 1 through 3. Login, the three wins, and the CO-STAR pattern for asking well. Almost everything that separates people who get a lot out of Claude from people who get a little is in those three parts.

If you read version 5, here is what is new

- **Models.** Sonnet 5 is still the everyday default. Opus 5 and Fable 5.1 now sit above it. Part 1.
- **Memory.** Claude now remembers between sessions and across chat and Cowork. Parts 7 and 8.
- **Office.** Corrected setup steps and what the cross-app connection actually does. Part 7.
- **Browser.** Claude in Chrome, plus a built-in browser inside Cowork. Part 7.

If you are already using it

Skip to Part 6 and set up a Project, then read Part 7 for the tools that have arrived since. Part 8 applies to everyone from day one, so read it whatever else you skip.

A word about the screenshots

The pictures in this guide were taken over several months, and Claude's interface changes often. Model names in particular move fast: a screenshot here may say Opus 4.7 or Sonnet 4.6 where your screen says something newer. Buttons move, menus get renamed, the habits stay the same. If your screen does not match a picture, trust your screen.

Nobody gets good at this by reading about it. Twenty minutes of actually using it beats an afternoon of preparing to use it.

START ANYWHERE. JUST START.

The basics

What Claude is, how to log in, and the sixty-second tour of the interface.

What Claude is, in one paragraph

Claude is an AI assistant made by a company called Anthropic. You type to it the same way you would write a message to a smart, well-read colleague who is fast, patient, and never tired. It can draft, edit, summarize, brainstorm, analyze data, and explain things. It can search the web when a question needs current information, and it can read the files you hand it. But at heart it is a thinking partner, not a search engine. The quality of what you get back depends almost entirely on the quality of what you put in. That is the whole game.

What Claude is good at vs. what it isn't

Good at: drafting first versions, restructuring messy notes, summarizing long documents, brainstorming, asking clarifying questions, explaining things in plain English, writing in a specified tone, and looking things up on the web when you ask it to.

Not good at: arithmetic at scale (hand it a spreadsheet instead and let it analyze the file), reading your mind, and replacing your judgment. Claude can be wrong, and it can be wrong confidently. You are still the editor.

A quick word about models

Near the message box you may notice a model picker. **Claude Sonnet 5** is the default and the right choice for nearly everything you will do. Above it sit **Claude Opus 5**, for long or complex reasoning and multi-step work, and **Claude Fable 5.1**, the heaviest model in the lineup, for the rare problem that defeats the others.

Ignore the picker until you are curious. The default is excellent, and it is faster than the bigger models. The lineup changes every few months. Nothing else in this guide changes with it.

Step 1 · Getting logged in

You will receive an email invitation from Anthropic indicating you have been invited to join Century Golf Partners on Claude. Open it on a desktop or laptop the first time. It is easier than mobile.



Join Century Golf Partners on Claude

Jim (jcreighton@centurygolf.com) has invited you to join Century Golf Partners's workspace on the Team plan.

Accept invite

By continuing, you agree to join the Team plan [managed by your admin](#) and acknowledge the Anthropic [Privacy Policy](#). [Learn more about the Team plan](#).

The invitation email. One click and you are in.

- 1 Click "Accept invite" in the email. The invitation expires after 21 days, so don't sit on it. If it lapses, ask Jim to resend it.
- 2 Sign in at [claude.ai](#) using your CGP email address. If you have never had a Claude account, you will be prompted to set a password, or you can sign in with Google if your CGP email is on Google Workspace.

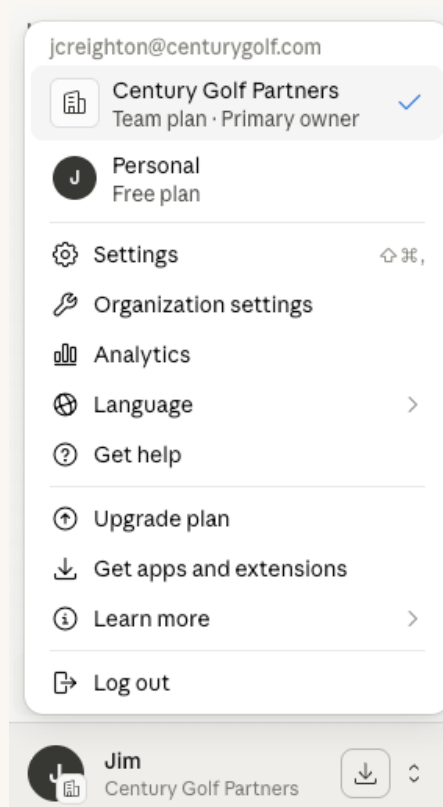
Think fast, build faster

Brainstorm in chat, build in Cowork

The sign-in screen at claude.ai. It features a light green background with a white rounded rectangle containing the sign-in options. At the top is a button with the Google logo and the text "Continue with Google". Below this is the word "OR" in small letters. Then there is a text input field labeled "Enter your email". Below the input field is a black button with the text "Continue with email". At the bottom of the white rectangle is a small line of text: "By continuing, you acknowledge Anthropic's [Privacy Policy](#) and agree to get occasional promotional emails and notifications." Below the white rectangle is a button with the Apple logo and the text "Download desktop app".

The sign-in screen at claude.ai.

- 3 Confirm you are in the Century Golf Partners workspace. Check the workspace name in the corner of the screen. If it shows a personal account instead, click the workspace name and switch.



The workspace switcher. Make sure "Century Golf Partners" has the checkmark.

- 4 **Set up your profile.** Add your full name and a photo if you would like. This is what teammates see when you share work inside Claude.
- 5 **Install the apps** (optional but recommended). The mobile app is in the App Store and Google Play. The desktop app, which unlocks Cowork and the built-in browser (more on both in Part 7), is at claude.ai/download. Sign in with the same email everywhere.

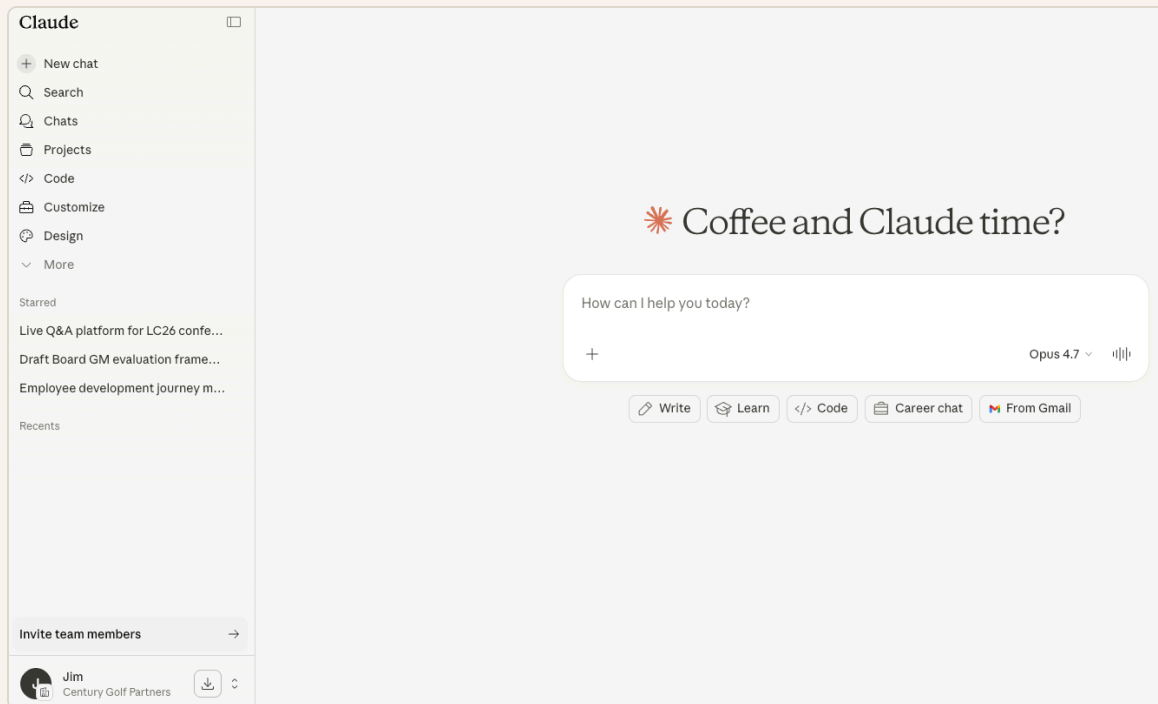
If something goes wrong

Didn't get the email? Check your spam folder, then ping Jim Creighton (jcreighton@centurygolf.com) and we will resend.

Can see Claude but not the CGP workspace? You are probably logged in with the wrong method (Google vs. email and password). Sign out, sign back in using the method shown in your invite, and try again.

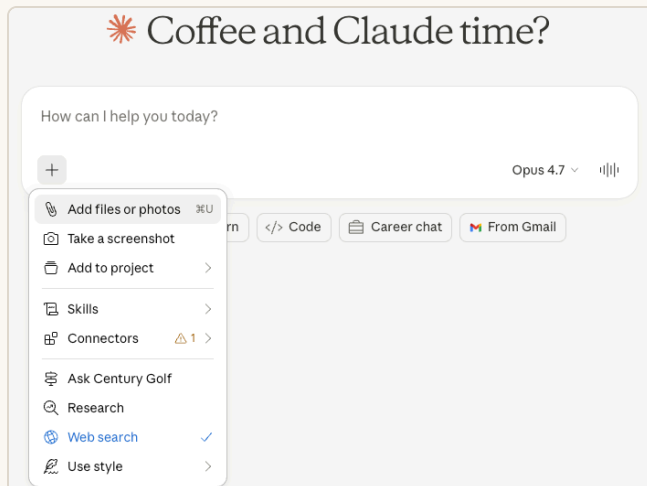
Step 2 · The interface in 60 seconds

When you open Claude, here is what you are looking at:

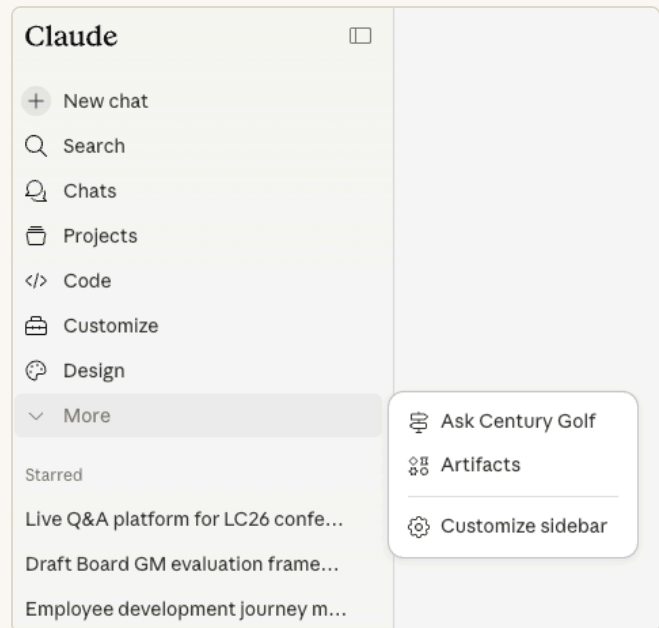


Home base. The chat box in the middle is where nearly everything starts.

- **The chat window.** The big text box in the middle. This is where you type. Hit Enter to send, Shift+Enter for a new line.
- **Sidebar: chats.** Every conversation is saved automatically. Click any past chat to pick up where you left off, or use Search to find one by keyword.
- **Sidebar: Projects.** Projects are workspaces with their own instructions and uploaded files. Think of a Project as a job role for Claude: "Member Survey Analyst," "Board Deck Builder." We cover these in Part 6.
- **The plus button.** Click the + next to the chat box to attach files (PDFs, Word docs, Excel sheets, images), turn on web search, or reach connectors and skills. Claude reads what you attach.
- **Artifacts.** When Claude produces something substantial, a long document, a chart, a working prototype, it appears in a side panel called an Artifact. You can edit it, copy it, or download it.
- **Sidebar: Customize.** This is where you connect Claude to your other tools (connectors), turn on skills, and set writing styles. Part 7 walks you through it.
- **Sidebar: Design and Code.** Two specialist workspaces. Design builds visual layouts and mockups. Code is for building software. Most of us will never open either, and that is fine.
- **"New chat" button.** Top of the sidebar. Use it often. One topic per chat is a healthy habit, and we will explain why.



The + menu: attach files, web search, connectors, skills.



The sidebar: chats, Projects, and more.

THE SINGLE MOST IMPORTANT HABIT

Start a new chat for each new task. Long, sprawling chats get confused. Claude tries to keep all the earlier context alive, which slows it down and muddles its answers. A new draft? New chat. New email? New chat. New question entirely? New chat. Cheap to do, big payoff.

Permission to mess around

Before you go any further: you cannot break Claude. There is no wrong prompt, no setting you will accidentally trigger, no file you can corrupt. The worst thing that happens is a bad draft you don't use. So try weird stuff. Ask it to argue with itself. Tell it the answer is wrong and see what it does. Push it. The people who get good at this fast are the ones who treat it like a sandbox, not a test.

You didn't learn this business from a binder. You learned it by walking the course. Claude works the same way: the learning is in the doing.

PERMISSION GRANTED. GO PLAY.

Your first three wins

Don't read about Claude. Use it. Try these three prompts in your first session. Copy, paste, customize. Each one is designed to give you a small useful result and a feel for how Claude responds.

Win #1 · Get smart on something fast

Pick anything you have been meaning to understand better: a term, a concept, a topic that comes up in meetings where you nod along. Try this:

PROMPT · COPY / PASTE

[customize the brackets](#)

Explain [topic] to me as if I'm new to it but smart. I work in golf club management. Cover:

1. The simplest possible definition
 2. Why it matters in practice
 3. The most common misconception about it
 4. One question I should ask if someone brings this up in a meeting
- Keep it under 250 words.

Win #2 · Rescue a stuck email

Pick an email you have been putting off, the one that needs to say something a little awkward. Try this:

PROMPT · COPY / PASTE

[customize the brackets](#)

I need to write an email to [name/role] about [situation]. Here's what I want them to do or know: [the actual point]. The tricky part: [what's making this hard: bad news, pushback, asking for something, etc.]

Give me three drafts:

1. Direct, minimal softening
2. Warm but clear
3. Diplomatic, protect the relationship

Keep each under 150 words. Don't use exclamation marks. Sound like a real person, not a chatbot.

Here is roughly what you will see come back. In this example, the awkward email is to a Tuesday tee-time regular whose posted scores don't match what the pro shop has on record:

Coffee and Claude time?

I need to write an email to Brad, our Tuesday tee-time regular who insists his 12 handicap is "trending down," about the fact that the pro shop has politely flagged his last six scorecards as mathematically improbable.

Here's what I want him to do or know: submit scores honestly, ideally before someone makes a spreadsheet about it.

The tricky part: Brad sponsors the member-guest, brings the good bourbon to the grill, and once cried during a Bill Murray movie at the holiday party. We need to keep him, just not at a 12.

Give me three drafts:

1. Direct, minimal softening
2. Warm but clear
3. Diplomatic, protect the relationship

Keep each under 150 words. Don't use exclamation marks. Sound like a real person, not a chatbot.

+

Sonnet 4.6 ▾



The situation, laid out plainly. Claude does its best work when you name the tricky part.

A Direct B Warm but clear C Protect the relationship

Subject: Scores — quick note

Brad,

Wanted to catch you before this became a conversation you didn't want to have.

The pro shop has reviewed your last six scorecards and flagged some inconsistencies. The short version: your posted scores don't reflect what's been recorded on the course.

Your handicap needs to reflect how you actually play. That means posting accurate scores going forward, every round.

No one is looking to make this a bigger deal than it needs to be. But it does need to be corrected, and you're the one who has to do it.

Let me know if you want to talk through it.

  Open in Mail ▾

Draft A: direct, minimal softening.

A Direct B Warm but clear C Protect the relationship

Subject: Wanted to give you a heads up

Brad,

You're one of the good ones around here, so I'd rather you hear this from me directly than through the grapevine.

The pro shop has been reviewing recent scorecards and yours have come up a few times. Six rounds flagged as inconsistent with what was recorded on the course. That's a handicap accuracy issue, and it needs to be cleaned up.

I know you love this club, and this club loves having you here. That's exactly why I'm asking you to start posting your actual scores. It protects you and keeps things square.

Let's grab five minutes this week and work out a path forward.

  Open in Mail ▾

Draft B: warm but clear.

A Direct B Warm but clear C Protect the relationship

Subject: Catching up — wanted to chat about something

Brad,

Always good to see you on Tuesdays. I've got something on my mind and figured you'd want to know.

The pro shop flags scorecards from time to time as part of routine index maintenance. Yours have come up six times recently, and the numbers aren't adding up the way they'd need to.

I'm not here to make anything of it — these things happen, and rounds get away from all of us. But the index has to reflect reality, and right now it doesn't.

If you start posting accurately from here, that's the end of it. Nobody needs to dig further.

Come find me this week. We'll keep it between us.

  Open in Mail ▾

Draft C: diplomatic, protects the relationship.

Three options above. A few notes on each:

Direct lands the legal threat gently ("before someone makes a spreadsheet") without saying it. Short sentences, no room to dodge.

Warm but clear uses Brad's relationship with the club as the reason to comply, not the pressure. "It protects you" does a lot of work there.

Diplomatic gives him the most cover. "Routine index maintenance" is technically accurate and lets him save face. The closer, "Nobody needs to dig further," is the real message.

My pick for someone like Brad: the warm version. He's emotionally invested in the club and responds to belonging. Direct might make him defensive. Diplomatic might let him rationalize doing nothing.



Claude's own notes on when each draft works best.

None of these drafts is necessarily the one you would send. That is the point: Claude gives you real options to choose from, and the choosing is still yours.

What you'll notice

Two things probably surprised you. First, Claude is faster than you expected. Second, the result is roughly 80% of the way there. The last 20% is your judgment, your edits, your voice. That is the whole working pattern. Claude drafts. You decide.

Twenty minutes ago that email was a dread on your to-do list. Now it's three drafts and a decision. That feeling is the reason this guide exists.

YOUR FIRST WIN, BANKED

Win #3 · Summarize a long document

Find any PDF or Word doc you have not had time to read: a vendor proposal, a board memo, an industry report. Click the + button in Claude, attach it, and say:

PROMPT · COPY / PASTE

attach the file first

Read the attached document. Give me:

1. A one-paragraph executive summary
2. The 3 most important takeaways
3. Anything I should be skeptical of, push back on, or follow up on
4. Any questions I should ask the sender

Start with whichever one has been sitting longest. Those are the documents where ninety seconds of Claude buys back an hour of avoidance.

How to prompt well

The one part worth reading twice. The single biggest predictor of how useful Claude is to you is how well you ask. Most people ask too vaguely, then blame the tool when the answer is generic. Here is the pattern we use at CGP.

CO-STAR: the prompt pattern

Six ingredients. You don't need all six every time, but the more of them you include, the sharper the answer.

- **C • Context.** What's the situation? Who's involved? "I'm the GM at a private club preparing for a board meeting next week..."
- **O • Objective.** What do you actually want the output to do? "Help me draft talking points that..."
- **S • Style.** What kind of writing? "Plain English, no jargon" or "conversational, like a teammate" or "formal, board-appropriate."
- **T • Tone.** Direct? Warm? Apologetic? Confident? Tone is different from style.
- **A • Audience.** Who reads this? "A skeptical board chair who pushes back on financials" gets a different draft than "new members who joined this month."
- **R • Response format.** Bullet list? Email? Short paragraph? Table? Tell Claude exactly how you want it laid out.

CO-STAR in action

Here is the difference between a realistic first attempt and a sharper version of the same task.

WEAK PROMPT	BETTER PROMPT
Write an email about the course closure.	Short email to our full membership about the back nine closing for aerification September 22 through 24. Front nine open with a modified pace. Matter of fact, not apologetic, this is routine annual maintenance. Under 150 words, signed by the Superintendent. Our members dislike being over-explained to, so skip the turf science.
Summarize this survey data.	Attached are 240 open-ended comments from our spring member survey. Give me the three most common themes with a rough count and two representative comments each, then flag anything rare that sounds urgent. Going to a board, so plain language.

Underneath the framework

Everything Claude gives you is a draft, not a deliverable. You are the author. This section is about getting a better first draft so your edit is shorter.

The rule behind every framework

Write to Claude the way you would write a note to a sharp new hire on their first day. Smart, quick, willing. Also brand new. Does not know your club, your members, your season, or why you are asking.

Nearly every disappointing result traces back to something you knew and did not say.

Three slots

CO-STAR is the full checklist. When you do not want a checklist, these are the three that carry the weight.

- 1 **Task.** What you want and what form it takes. An email, five bullets, a one-page summary.
- 2 **Context.** Who it is for, what happened before, what limits apply. Names, dates, tone, length.
- 3 **Good looks like.** Paste an example you liked, or name the standard it has to hit.

The third slot is the one people skip and the one that does the most work.

Specific is not the same as long

Look back at the two better prompts on page 12. Neither one is longer than a text you would actually send a colleague. You are not writing a spec. You are just saying out loud what you already know.

The habit that matters more than the prompt

Read the first output and push back once. The common mistake is not a weak prompt, it is accepting draft one. Say what is wrong: "Too formal, cut it in half." "You missed the dues piece." "Give me three shorter options."

One round of pushback beats twenty minutes of prompt rewriting. Lines worth stealing:

- "Cut this in half. Keep the strongest parts."
- "Make it 30% more direct. Less hedging."
- "Rewrite this in the voice of someone who's been at the club for 20 years."
- "Now give me the version that pushes back on the board, not the one that agrees with them."
- "What's the strongest counterargument to what you just wrote?"
- "Pretend you're a skeptical CFO reading this. What would you challenge?"

Claude does not get tired or defensive. You can ask for the fifth rewrite without burning anyone's patience. Use that.

Quick reference

ASK YOURSELF	EXAMPLE
What am I asking for, in what form?	"A 200 word email"
What does Claude not know that I know?	"Third time we have moved this event"
What would make this good?	"Something I could send without editing"
Did I push back on draft one?	"Shorter, warmer, drop the last paragraph"

Read it, fix it, own it. Your name is on what goes out.

THE AUTHOR IS STILL YOU

Productivity plays for CGP work

Five prompts you will actually use. One for member communications, two for daily ops, two for coaching. Save the ones that fit your role. Customize the brackets. All of them are collected in Appendix B.

Member communications

SURVEY WRITEUP · EXECUTIVE BRIEF

attach the survey export

Attached is our member survey from [club name]. Total responses: [n].
Build me a 1-page executive brief for the board with:

1. Headline finding (1 sentence)
2. Top 3 themes from open comments, each with a representative quote
3. The biggest gap between member expectation and experience
4. 3 recommended actions, ranked by impact and effort
5. Any data point I should be careful about presenting verbatim, and why

Format as headed sections, not slides. Plain English.

Daily operations

MEETING AGENDA FROM A BRAIN-DUMP

Here's a brain-dump of everything I want to cover in [meeting name] on [date] with [attendees]. Build me a tight agenda:

- Time-boxed (total length: [X] minutes)
- Each item labeled as Discuss / Decide / Inform
- Owner for each item where I named one
- 5 minutes at the end for action review

BRAIN-DUMP: [paste]

"WHAT AM I MISSING" CHECK

Below is [a draft / a plan / a decision I'm leaning toward]. Before I send/commit:

1. What's the strongest objection someone could raise?
2. What assumption am I making that might not hold?
3. Who is most likely to be unhappy with this, and why?
4. What's one thing I haven't considered?

Be direct. I'd rather get the pushback now than from a board member next week.

DRAFT/PLAN: [paste]

Coaching & people development

PRE-CONVERSATION PREP · PERFORMANCE FEEDBACK

I'm having a feedback conversation with [role, e.g., a club GM] tomorrow.

The strength to recognize: [specific behavior + impact]

The development area: [specific behavior + impact]

What I want from the conversation: [their commitment / a plan / mutual understanding]

Help me prepare with:

1. A 2-minute opening that frames the conversation as developmental, not punitive
2. The exact words I'll use to name the development area (specific, behavior-based, not character-based)
3. 3 questions I should ask before I give my view
4. The most likely defensive reaction and how I'd respond without escalating
5. A clean close that lands on a next step

IDP DRAFT · INDIVIDUAL DEVELOPMENT PLAN

I'm building an IDP for [role, e.g., assistant GM at private club, 3 years in role, ready for stretch].

Their strengths: [list]

Their growth areas: [list]

Their stated career goal: [what they told me]

My read on their readiness: [yours]

Draft an IDP with:

- 2 development goals tied to their growth areas (not their strengths)
- For each goal: a measurable outcome, 3 actions, and a 90-day check-in question
- One stretch assignment they could take on inside their current role
- 1-2 reading or learning recommendations

Keep it to 1 page. Plain English. No HR boilerplate.

An hour saved on the memo is an hour returned to the floor, the range, the dining room, the team. That trade never stops being worth it.

WHERE THE TIME GOES

Creativity plays

Productivity is what gets your work done. Creativity is what makes it better. These prompts pull Claude into the role of thinking partner rather than draft factory.

Reframe a problem

THE REFRAME

Here's a problem I'm stuck on: `[describe it]`
Give me 5 different ways to reframe this problem. Each reframe should:

- Change the question I'm asking, not just the answer
- Open up a different set of possible solutions
- Be specific enough that I could explain it in a meeting

After the 5, tell me which reframe you think is most underexplored, and why.

Brainstorm without bad ideas

BRAINSTORM WITH QUALITY CONTROL

I need ideas for `[specific challenge, e.g., 'a member retention initiative for empty-nesters who joined for golf 15 years ago and now play less']`.
Generate 15 ideas. Then:

- Eliminate the 8 most obvious ones (the ones any consultant would suggest)
- Of the remaining 7, mark which are low-cost vs. high-cost
- Pick the one most likely to be both effective and surprising, and explain why

Stress-test your own thinking

STEEL-MAN THE OTHER SIDE

I'm leaning toward `[decision/position]`. Before I commit, build me the strongest possible case AGAINST it. Don't be polite. Don't hedge. Make me defend my position. Then tell me which of your counterarguments I should take most seriously.

Name something well

NAMING

I need a name for [a program/event/initiative]. The thing it does: [describe]. The audience: [who uses or attends]. The feeling I want: [aspirational, casual, internal-only, etc.].

Give me 12 names across 4 styles:

- 3 plain and descriptive
- 3 evocative or metaphorical
- 3 short and sharp (one or two words)
- 3 unconventional or playful

For each, one sentence on what it signals. Then tell me your top pick.

Write in someone else's voice (carefully)

This one is useful for prepping how a message will land, not for impersonation. Try: "Read this draft and tell me how it would sound to a 65-year-old member who has been at the club since the renovation in 2008 and is on a fixed income." Voice as audience test, not voice as ghostwriter.

The best ideas at a club rarely arrive in a meeting. They arrive on the cart path, half-formed. Claude is where half-formed goes to become finished.

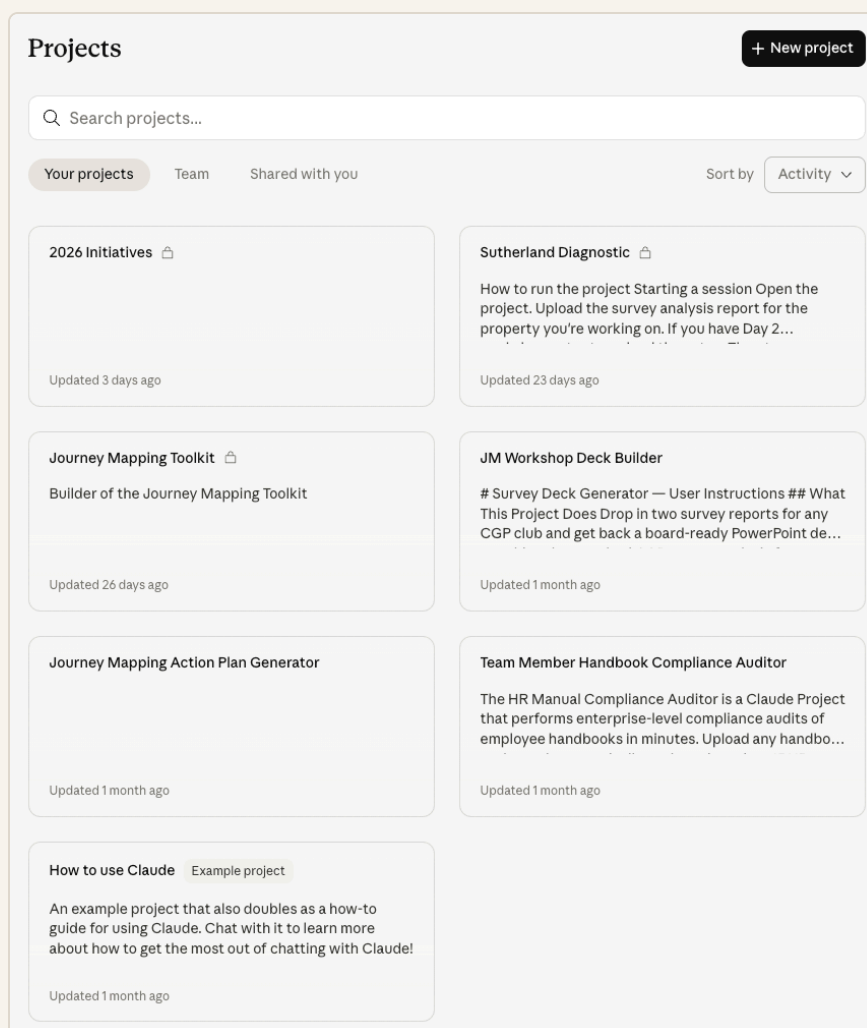
THINKING PARTNER, ON CALL

Projects: when you're ready to level up

Once you have used Claude for a couple of weeks, you will notice you are typing the same context over and over. "I'm at a private club..." "My audience is members..." "Keep it under one page..." That is the signal it is time to use a Project.

What a Project is

A Project is a dedicated workspace inside Claude with two extra superpowers: persistent instructions and uploaded files. Instead of repeating yourself, you set the context once. Every chat inside that Project starts with that context already loaded. Projects are private to you by default; you choose what to share with the team.



The Projects screen. Ours already includes shared CGP Projects you can open and use today.

How to set one up

- 1 In the left sidebar, click **Projects**, then **Create Project**.
- 2 **Name it for the deliverable, not the topic.** Good: "Member Survey Briefs." Less good: "Member Stuff."
- 3 **Add a description.** One sentence on what this Project is for.
- 4 **Add custom instructions.** Tell Claude who you are, what you do, and how you want it to respond.
Example: "You are helping me, [name], build executive briefs from member surveys for CGP private clubs. Always output in plain English. Lead with the recommendation, not the background. Flag anything you'd be cautious about presenting verbatim."
- 5 **Upload reference files.** The CGP brand voice guide, a previous board deck, a sample brief in your preferred format, an industry report. Claude reads these as context for every chat in the Project.
- 6 **Set sharing.** If your team should see and use the Project, share it with the workspace. If it is yours, keep it private.

Three Projects worth setting up in your first month

- **Email Drafts.** Your communication style, your common audiences, your kill-list of phrases you hate.
- **Meeting Prep.** Your meeting cadence, the people you regularly meet with, your preferred agenda format.
- **The role-specific one.** For you, that is whatever your job actually produces. Survey briefs. Operator updates. Onboarding plans. F&B reviews.

A Project is you, teaching Claude your job once, so you never have to explain it again. Ten minutes of setup pays rent every single day.

LEVEL TWO, UNLOCKED

Projects vs. memory: which one holds what

Claude can now remember things between conversations on its own (Part 7 covers this properly). That raises a fair question: if Claude remembers, why bother with a Project?

They do different jobs, and the distinction is worth learning once.

A PROJECT HOLDS	MEMORY HOLDS
Context you chose, deliberately, for one kind of work. Your instructions, your reference files, your format. It applies inside that Project and nowhere else, and it stays exactly as you wrote it until you change it.	Context Claude picked up as you worked, across everything you do. Useful, general, and editable, but not something you authored line by line.

The practical rule: if you would want a new colleague to read it before doing this task, it belongs in a Project. If it is just true about you generally, memory will pick it up on its own.

One thing worth doing today

Open the shared CGP Projects already in your workspace before you build your own. Several of the jobs you are about to set up have been built once already, and starting from one of those beats starting from a blank box.

Beyond chat: the wider Claude toolkit

Chat is where you start. Claude has also grown into the tools you already work in: your Office files, your browser, your inbox. None of this is required reading for week one, but know it exists, because one of these will eventually save you an afternoon.

Three ways to work: Chat, Cowork, and Code

You will see all three in the sidebar. They are the same Claude underneath. What changes is how much of the work you hand over.

Chat	Cowork	Code
WHAT IT IS A conversation. You ask, Claude answers, you refine. Everything in Parts 1 to 5 of this guide happens here.	WHAT IT IS A workspace where you hand over a whole multi-step job instead of steering each turn. On desktop you can point it at a folder on your computer. On web and mobile you give it the files.	WHAT IT IS Claude for building software. It writes, tests, and fixes code across entire technical projects.
WHAT YOU GET BACK An answer in the conversation, or a document in the side panel you can copy or download.	WHAT YOU GET BACK Finished files. A folder of them, if that is what the job needed.	WHAT YOU GET BACK Working software.
BEST FOR Drafts, edits, summaries, brainstorm, quick questions, thinking out loud. One deliverable at a time.	BEST FOR Multi-step jobs across many files: "turn these 12 survey exports into one board brief," recurring reports, file cleanup and organizing.	BEST FOR Technical staff and vendors. Most of us at CGP will never need it, and that is fine.
HOW IT FEELS Texting a smart colleague. You steer every turn.	HOW IT FEELS Handing off a project and getting the finished work back, rather than watching every step.	HOW IT FEELS Hiring a fast software developer who documents everything.
WHERE claude.ai, mobile app, desktop app.	WHERE Desktop, web, and mobile. The desktop version can reach your own files and has its own browser.	WHERE "Code" in the sidebar, or the terminal for developers.

The simple rule: start in Chat. Move to Cowork when the task involves many files or many steps. Leave Code to the technical folks unless curiosity gets the better of you.

The building blocks: Projects, Artifacts, and Skills

Three words you will hear constantly. Here is what each one is and what it is for.

Projects · *reusable context*

What it is: a dedicated workspace with persistent instructions and uploaded reference files. **Purpose:** stop repeating yourself. Teach Claude your role, your audience, and your format once, and every chat inside the Project starts already briefed. Part 6 shows you how to build one.

Artifacts · *the work product*

What it is: the side panel where Claude's substantial outputs live: documents, tables, charts, even small interactive tools. **Purpose:** separate the deliverable from the conversation. You can edit an Artifact directly, ask Claude to revise it, copy it, or download it as a file. If the chat is the kitchen, the Artifact is the plate that goes out.

Skills · *repeatable know-how*

What it is: a reusable recipe of instructions and examples that teaches Claude to produce a specific deliverable the CPG way, like our expense report format or a standard operator update. **Purpose:** consistency without re-explaining. Skills we build centrally appear for everyone in the workspace. If you give Claude the same instructions weekly, tell Jim. That is a skill waiting to be built.

How they fit together: a **Project** holds your standing context, a **skill** holds a repeatable method, and an **Artifact** is where the finished piece lands. You can use all three in a single chat.

Memory: Claude remembers between sessions NEW

Claude now carries context from one conversation to the next, and that memory is shared between Chat and Cowork. Mention in chat that you are preparing for the October board meeting, and a Cowork session next week already knows.

Memory is organized into topics you can read, edit, and delete in your settings. Sensitive topics stay opt-in, off unless you deliberately turn them on. Two practical notes. First, memory is useful precisely because it persists, which means the house rules in Part 8 matter more, not less: what you would not paste into a single chat, do not teach Claude to remember. Second, if an answer seems to be dragging in context you don't want, open your memory settings and look at what is stored there.

Connecting your tools: the Customize tab

Connectors link Claude to tools like Gmail, Google Calendar, Google Drive, Microsoft 365, and Slack, so it can pull real context instead of you pasting it. "Find the thread where we discussed the irrigation bid and summarize where it landed" becomes a one-line request. Here is how to set them up:

- 1 In the left sidebar, click **Customize**. This is the control room for connectors, skills, and writing styles.
- 2 Open the **Connectors** section and browse the list. Click **Connect** on the tool you want, then sign in with your CGP work account when prompted. That is the whole setup.
- 3 While you are there, check the **Skills** section to see what CGP has already built for you, and **Styles** if you want Claude to learn your writing voice.
- 4 Back in any chat, click the + button to see your connected tools and turn them on or off for that conversation.

You control which connectors are on, and you can disconnect any of them from the same tab. The house rules in Part 8 apply to connected data exactly as they do to pasted data: work accounts only, and think before connecting anything sensitive.

NEW

Claude in Excel, Word, PowerPoint, and Outlook

Claude now works inside Microsoft Office, and it is included with our Team plan at no extra cost. Claude can build and explain spreadsheet models, draft documents in place, assemble slide outlines, and help you work through an inbox. If you live in Office all day, this is the fastest path to real value.

Setup is three steps, in order:

- 1 **Ask Jim to turn on Office agents** for the CGP workspace. It is an owner setting, and nothing works until it is on.
- 2 **Install the add-ins from the Microsoft Marketplace** for the apps you use.
- 3 **Open each app once and activate the add-in**, then turn on the cross-app setting inside each one.

With cross-app on, Claude carries context between Office apps *within a working session*, so the model you discussed in Excel is available when you move to the related PowerPoint deck. That context is per session, not permanent: cross-app chat history is not saved between sessions, so finish a piece of work in one sitting where you can.

NEW Claude in your browser

Claude is now available as a Chrome extension on every paid plan, which puts it in a side panel next to whatever you are looking at. It reads the page you are on and can act on it: filling a form, pulling numbers out of a vendor portal, working through a booking system. It can take those actions on its own, with a safety check reviewing each one against what you actually asked for, and you can switch that off in settings so it asks you before every action. On the desktop app, Cowork also has its own built-in browser, separate from your Chrome, for the same kind of work in a place where your personal tabs and logins are not in play.

Because a browsing agent acts on live pages rather than just talking about them, give it more supervision than a chat window. One task at a time, watch what it does the first few times, and do not turn it loose on anything that moves money or changes a member record. If you are new to it, turn on approval for every action until you trust what you are seeing.

USEFUL Web search and research

Claude can search the web when a question needs current information, and a deeper Research mode can spend several minutes gathering and citing sources for bigger questions: market comparisons, industry trends, competitive scans. Sources come back cited so you can check them. And you should. Part 8 explains why.

Where to start with all this

Don't try to adopt everything at once. The path that works: get fluent in Chat (Parts 1 to 5), set up one Project (Part 6), then add the one tool from this part that touches your daily work most. For most of us that is Claude in Excel or a connector to email.

The clubs that win with AI won't be the ones with the fanciest tools. They'll be the ones with the best habits. Habits are free, and they start this week.

THE LONG GAME

What you can safely ignore

Claude ships new capabilities most months, and the list in this part will be longer by the time you read it. That is not a reason to feel behind. A short guide to what deserves your attention and what does not:

- **Ignore the model picker.** The default is chosen because it is right for almost everything. Changing it is a rounding error next to writing a better prompt.
- **Ignore Code entirely** unless you write software.
- **Ignore any feature you cannot name a task for.** If you cannot finish the sentence "I would use this to __," it is not for you yet. It will still be there in three months.
- **Do not ignore Part 8.** The house rules are the one section that applies to everybody from the first session.

The people at CGP getting the most out of Claude are not the ones who have tried every feature. They are the ones who use two or three of them constantly.

A FAIR QUESTION: IS THIS GOING TO REPLACE MY JOB?

It has come up in every cohort so far, so let's answer it plainly. Claude drafts, summarizes, and analyzes. It does not walk the course, read a room, calm down an angry member, or decide what our clubs should do next. What it changes is the mix of your week: less time producing documents, more time on the conversations and judgment calls that were always the actual work. That is a trade worth making, and it is why we are investing in teaching everyone to use it well rather than quietly letting a few people figure it out.

House rules at CGP

Claude is a powerful tool, and like any powerful tool, it needs a few guardrails. These rules apply to everyone using Claude under the CGP workspace, in chat, in Office, in Cowork, in the browser, and through connectors.

THE ONE RULE THAT MATTERS MOST

Do not paste member personally identifiable information or employee personnel records into Claude. Ever.

That means no member names tied to financial data, medical information, or anything sensitive. No employee disciplinary records, compensation tied to names, or full HR files. No credit card numbers, social security numbers, or full bank account numbers, under any circumstance.

Discussing a coaching situation in general terms is fine. "Member 247 said X" is fine. "John Smith said X about his medical issue" is not. When in doubt, strip the names and numbers before you paste.

What you can put into Claude

- Internal documents, drafts, agendas, plans, your own notes.
- Member survey data when it has been de-identified (no individual names tied to comments).
- Financial summaries at the level you would share in a board packet.
- Vendor proposals, RFPs, public industry reports.
- Anything you would be comfortable having a CGP colleague see.

What else to be careful with

- Legal documents under active dispute or attorney-client privileged material. Check with leadership first.
- Anything you would hesitate to email outside the company.
- Drafts of decisions that have not been announced internally yet. The conversation stays in your CGP workspace, but treat it like any other internal channel.
- Connectors and Cowork give Claude reach into email and files. The same rules apply there: connect work accounts only, and think before pointing Claude at a folder that contains sensitive records.

New surfaces, same rules

- **Memory carries between sessions and across Chat and Cowork.** The same rules apply to what Claude remembers as to what you paste. You can review, edit, and delete stored topics in your settings, and sensitive topics stay off unless you turn them on.
- **Browser tools act on live pages.** Watch what they do before trusting them with anything that changes a record or spends money.

The data security promise, and the limit of it

By default, Anthropic does not train its models on our CGP workspace conversations. That is the standing arrangement for commercial plans including Team, and it is why we use this version rather than personal accounts.

But "not used for training" is not the same as "impossible for anything to ever go wrong." Treat Claude like a smart consultant under NDA: useful for almost anything, but you still would not hand them every file in the building. Use judgment.

Always verify before sending

Claude can produce text that sounds confident and is wrong. This is true of every AI tool on the market right now, and it is the single biggest risk in using one. The rule:

IF A FACT, NUMBER, NAME, OR QUOTE MATTERS, VERIFY IT

Claude can invent statistics, misattribute quotes, mis-summarize a document, or get a date wrong. Web search and cited sources help, but they do not remove the duty to check. For drafts and brainstorming, imperfection is fine. For anything going to a member, board, vendor, or regulator, you check before sending. Always.

The one-sentence version of Part 8

Strip the names, check the numbers, and don't hand it anything you wouldn't hand a contractor working in the building. Everything else in this part is a footnote to that.

Getting unstuck

Common frustrations and the fix.

"Claude's answer is too generic."

You didn't give it enough context. Add who you are, who the audience is, what the output is for. Generic input, generic output.

"It keeps writing in a corporate, soulless voice."

Tell it not to. Try: "Don't use the words 'leverage,' 'optimize,' 'best-in-class,' or 'unparalleled.' Sound like a person who works at a golf club, not a consultant." Be explicit about your kill-list.

"It gave me five paragraphs when I wanted one."

Tell it the length up front. "Under 100 words." "3 sentences." "One paragraph." Or after the fact: "Cut this to a third. Keep the strongest parts."

"It's repeating itself or going in circles."

The chat has gotten too long and the context is muddled. Start a new chat. Paste in only the most recent draft and ask for the next iteration there.

"It told me something that's wrong."

Push back. "That's not right, because [explain]. Try again." Claude will correct itself, and the corrected version is usually accurate. If you keep getting wrong answers on the same topic, it is a topic where you should verify externally regardless.

"It's using something about me I never told it."

That will be memory, which now carries across chats and Cowork. Open your settings, look at the stored topics, and edit or delete anything you don't want it drawing on.

"I don't know how to start."

Try this universal opener: "I'm trying to [goal]. Before you write anything, ask me 5 clarifying questions to make sure you understand what I need." Claude will interview you. Answer the questions. Then ask it to draft.

Where to get help

- **Jim Creighton.** Your first call. Email jcreighton@centurygolf.com or grab me at the next leadership meeting.
 - **The thumbs-down button.** Below every Claude response. If something was off, hit it and add a note. The feedback goes to Anthropic and shapes how the model is improved.
 - **Anthropic's help center.** support.claude.com. Good for technical issues: login, billing, app problems.
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One last thing.
Pick one thing on your plate this week.
Try Claude on it. Notice what changed.

That is the whole onboarding. Welcome aboard.

Jim

The one-page cheat sheet

Print it. Pin it. Everything in this guide, boiled down to one page.

The five habits

1. **New task, new chat.** Long chats get muddled. Fresh chats stay sharp.
2. **Tell it who, who, and what.** Who you are, who the audience is, what the output should look like.
3. **Iterate.** The first draft is the starting point. "Cut it in half." "More direct." "Now argue against it."
4. **Verify what matters.** Facts, numbers, names, and quotes get checked before they leave the building.
5. **No member PII, no personnel records.** Ever. Strip names and numbers before you paste, and before Claude remembers.

CO-STAR at a glance

Context (the situation) • **O**bjective (what the output must do) • **S**tyl (kind of writing) • **T**one (how it should feel) • **A**udience (who reads it) • **R**esponse format (how it is laid out)

The universal opener

WHEN YOU DON'T KNOW HOW TO START

I'm trying to [goal]. Before you write anything, ask me 5 clarifying questions to make sure you understand what I need.

Fast fixes

Too generic? Add context. **Too corporate?** Give it a kill-list of words. **Too long?** State a length. **Going in circles?** New chat. **Wrong?** Push back and verify. **Knows something odd about you?** Check your memory settings.

Help

Jim Creighton (jcreighton@centurygolf.com) • support.claude.com

The CGP prompt library

Every copy/paste prompt from this guide, in one place. Customize the bracketed parts, then make them yours.

Learn & understand

GET SMART FAST

Explain [topic] to me as if I'm new to it but smart. I work in golf club management. Cover: 1. The simplest possible definition 2. Why it matters in practice 3. The most common misconception about it 4. One question I should ask if someone brings this up in a meeting. Under 250 words.

SUMMARIZE A DOCUMENT

attach the file

Read the attached document. Give me: 1. A one-paragraph executive summary 2. The 3 most important takeaways 3. Anything I should be skeptical of, push back on, or follow up on 4. Any questions I should ask the sender

Write & communicate

RESCUE A STUCK EMAIL

I need to write an email to [name/role] about [situation]. Here's what I want them to do or know: [the point]. The tricky part: [what makes it hard]. Give me three drafts: 1. Direct, minimal softening 2. Warm but clear 3. Diplomatic, protect the relationship. Under 150 words each. No exclamation marks. Sound like a real person, not a chatbot.

SURVEY WRITEUP · EXECUTIVE BRIEF

attach the survey

Attached is our member survey from [club]. Total responses: [n]. Build a 1-page executive brief for the board: 1. Headline finding 2. Top 3 themes from open comments with a representative quote each 3. Biggest gap between member expectation and experience 4. 3 recommended actions ranked by impact and effort 5. Any data point to be careful presenting verbatim, and why. Headed sections, not slides. Plain English.

Run the day

AGENDA FROM A BRAIN-DUMP

Here's a brain-dump for [meeting] on [date] with [attendees]. Build a tight agenda: time-boxed to [X] minutes; each item labeled Discuss / Decide / Inform; owner for each item where named; 5 minutes at the end for action review. BRAIN-DUMP: [paste]

"WHAT AM I MISSING" CHECK

Below is [a draft / plan / decision]. Before I commit: 1. Strongest objection someone could raise? 2. What assumption might not hold? 3. Who will be unhappy, and why? 4. One thing I haven't considered? Be direct. DRAFT/PLAN: [paste]

Coach & develop

FEEDBACK CONVERSATION PREP

I'm having a feedback conversation with [role] tomorrow. Strength to recognize: [behavior + impact]. Development area: [behavior + impact]. What I want: [outcome]. Prepare me with: 1. A 2-minute developmental opening 2. Exact words to name the development area (behavior-based) 3. 3 questions to ask before giving my view 4. Likely defensive reaction and my response 5. A clean close landing on a next step

IDP DRAFT

Build an IDP for [role and situation]. Strengths: [list]. Growth areas: [list]. Career goal: [stated]. My read on readiness: [yours]. Include: 2 development goals tied to growth areas; for each, a measurable outcome, 3 actions, and a 90-day check-in question; one stretch assignment inside their current role; 1-2 learning recommendations. 1 page. Plain English. No HR boilerplate.

Think & create

THE REFRAME

Here's a problem I'm stuck on: `[describe]`. Give me 5 ways to reframe it. Each should change the question, open different solutions, and be specific enough to explain in a meeting. Then tell me which reframe is most underexplored, and why.

BRAINSTORM WITH QUALITY CONTROL

I need ideas for `[specific challenge]`. Generate 15. Then eliminate the 8 most obvious, mark the rest low-cost vs. high-cost, and pick the one most likely to be both effective and surprising. Explain why.

STEEL-MAN THE OTHER SIDE

I'm leaning toward `[decision]`. Build the strongest possible case AGAINST it. Don't be polite. Don't hedge. Then tell me which counterargument I should take most seriously.

NAMING

I need a name for `[program/event/initiative]`. What it does: `[describe]`. Audience: `[who]`. Feeling: `[aspirational, casual, etc.]`. Give me 12 names across 4 styles: 3 plain, 3 evocative, 3 short and sharp, 3 playful. One sentence on what each signals. Then your top pick.

Copy one of these into a new chat before you close this guide. The library only works if something in it gets used today.

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